

A young man and a young woman are smiling and standing outdoors. They are both wearing bright green polo shirts with a "DANCE MARATHON" logo on the chest. The man is also wearing a blue and white patterned headband and holding a smartphone. The woman is wearing a pink beaded necklace and white pants. In the background, there is a large, circular, metallic gong hanging from a wooden frame. The setting appears to be a campus with a building and trees in the distance.

DANCE MARATHON AT THE UNIVERSITY OF FLORIDA

SPONSORSHIP OPPORTUNITIES 2026-2027

 **DANCE MARATHON**
AT THE UNIVERSITY OF FLORIDA



ABOUT DM AT UF

Dance Marathon at the University of Florida (DM at UF) is one of the top highest fundraising Children's Miracle Network Dance Marathons in the nation. With the support of many community and corporate partners, DM at UF raised \$1,152,326.32 while celebrating their 32nd year in 2026! DM at UF is one of the original five founding Dance Marathon programs and since our start, we have raised more than \$34 million for UF Health Shands Children's Hospital, a member hospital of Children's Miracle Network.

Starting in the summer and continuing throughout the entire year, DM at UF motivates students to advocate for advancements to pediatric healthcare by raising critical funds needed by our local hospital. Together, through the students' peer-to-peer fundraising efforts, special events and community and business sponsors, DM at UF garners financial support for the greatest needs of UF Health Shands Children's Hospital, ensuring patients & families can receive the care they need and deserve. All of these funds are celebrated and announced during our Total Reveal at our Main Event each spring semester. This event, hosted at Exactech Arena at the Stephen C. O'Connell Center, brings students together who are fighting to Make Big Change, For All Kids. Students come together for an immersive, high-energy event that celebrates the resilience of patients at UF Health Shands Children's Hospital while raising critical funds and awareness for their care.

ABOUT CMN AND UF HEALTH SHANDS CHILDREN'S HOSPITAL

UF Health Shands Children's hospital is our local Children's Miracle Network hospital. CMN is an international non-profit organization dedicated to raising funds and awareness for children's hospitals. CMN's founding pledge, to keep all donations in the area in which they were raised, remains at the core of their philosophy.

Throughout this partnership with Children's Miracle Network at UF Health Shands Children's Hospital, DM at UF has the ability to serve the children coming to the hospital for medical care. With all funds going directly back to UF Health Shands Children's Hospital, DM at UF is able to make an incredible impact on the lives of children and families who need advanced medical treatment. Every dollar we raise ensures our hospital is well-equipped with the proper tools whenever children need them most. Our funds have helped purchase life-saving equipment, fund ground-breaking research and provide funds for diversionary and social support programs that would otherwise not be possible. We are making a difference for children and families today, tomorrow and for years to come.

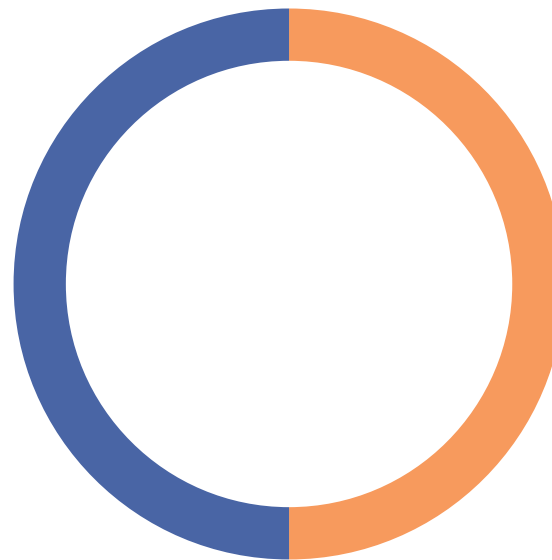


DANCE MARATHON IMPACT

100%

of funds raised each year go to UF Health Shands Children's Hospital

With donations coming in from around the world, DM at UF's fight and passion for the past 32 years is well-recognized by parents, alumni, local businesses and corporations. Last year, there were 11,823 unique online donations.



50%
RESEARCH

50%
PATIENT CARE
AND PROGRAMS,
EQUIPMENT
AND CAPITAL
IMPROVEMENTS

DANCE MARATHON IN NUMBERS

14

K-12 DANCE MARATHONS

1,357

TOTAL PARTICIPANTS

\$1,152,326.32

RAISED IN 2026

\$34 MILLION+

RAISED SINCE 1995

17.6K

FACEBOOK FOLLOWERS

14.1K

INSTAGRAM FOLLOWERS

10.1K

INSTAGRAM IMPRESSIONS PER POST



BECOMING A SPONSOR

Every year, DM at UF engages new and returning sponsors to support our organization. Through monetary and/or in kind donations, businesses are able to support our cause while gaining access to our community and partnership benefits.

Dance Marathon at UF reaches communities across a variety of demographics. These demographics include our participants, college students aged 18-23 and our donors who are on average aged 33-54. Working together, we can help your business reach all the different audiences that we have access to. With the help of our marketing teams, we will produce content and advertisements that adheres to both of our marketing guidelines.

Over the past three decades, DM at UF has significantly impacted the lives of children and families receiving treatment at UF Health Shands Children's Hospital. Being in close proximity to UF Health Shands Children's Hospital fills us with pride as we witness the profound impact we create within the greater Gainesville community. Our collaborative efforts with partners, including your esteemed business, have enabled us to ensure that children in our community receive access to advanced levels of care at our local Children's Miracle Network hospital. Working hand in hand with partners like you empowers us to extend the reach of our impact on pediatric healthcare, guaranteeing that every child receives the care they rightfully deserve and require.

Tax Exempt Status:

Dance Marathon at the University of Florida supports UF Health Shands Children's Hospital, a 501c(3).

Federal Employer Identification Number for Shands Teaching Hospital and Clinics, Inc. dba Children's Miracle Network at Shands: 59-1943502

STUDENT IMPACT

With an Overall Director Team of 19, 57 Assistant Directors and more than 250 Captains, Dance Marathon at the University of Florida provides students with hands-on leadership and professional development opportunities that extend far beyond the classroom. Through direct collaboration with corporate sponsors, management of real budgets and development of strategic initiatives, students gain meaningful experience in areas such as marketing, public relations, finance, fundraising, communications and event operations.

This year alone, over 350 students have the opportunity to grow personally and professionally while making a tangible impact for patients and families at UF Health Shands Children's Hospital. UF students are able to find their passions and continue to impact children's health beyond DM at UF through work in nursing, pharmacy and other jobs. Our organization gives students opportunities to grow as leaders and prepare for careers beyond their time at the University of Florida. By working through real-world challenges and creating innovative solutions, students develop transferable skills that closely mirror the demands of today's workforce.

While Dance Marathon at UF's mission is to support UF Health Shands Children's Hospital, the organization also serves as a transformative leadership experience that equips University of Florida students with practical skills, professional confidence and a strong foundation to prepare students for future careers.



MAIN EVENT SPONSORSHIP OPPORTUNITIES

At DM at UF's Main Event, there are various sponsorship opportunities! We organize many activities and events to keep over 200 participants entertained and excited. Listed below are some of the following highlight features that shine at our Main Event, and are continuously looked forward to each year!

THE GONG

The Gong represents the heartbeat of our event and is one of the most recognizable features. Not only does our gong travel around North Central Florida to all of our K-12 Dance Marathons, but it is also present at most campus events for participants to celebrate their fundraising milestones! Associate your company with one of Dance Marathon's most recognizable and enduring traditions.

FAMILY ROOM

The Family Room is created by the Family Relations team to ensure that every Miracle Family in attendance feels comfortable and has a special place to gather. Each year, the Family Room has a unique, fun theme, with various activities for Miracle Families to complete and have fun! Create positive brand associations through direct support of the families at the heart of Dance Marathon's mission.

PRESENTING SPONSOR

As the Presenting Sponsor, your organization will be recognized as the premier sponsor of Dance Marathon at UF's Main Event. Your brand will be featured across event advertising and promotional materials leading up to and throughout the event at the Stephen C. O'Connell Center. With more than 500 attendees, including students, alumni, university leadership, Miracle Families and community members, you will have the opportunity to engage directly with our audience, take part in the event program and align your organization with our mission of supporting patients and families at UF Health Shands Children's hospital.

THEME HOUR

Throughout the event, theme hours are announced to the crowd of Miracle Makers and attendees to bring excitement and fun to the floor. Themes encourage participants to dress up and continue dancing and fundraising for a great cause. Connect your company with the energy, excitement and creativity that keep participants motivated.

SIDE STAGE

The Side Stage is viewed by thousands during the event. Viewers are able to watch the stage for encouragement as well as to learn the line dance. On this stage, our miracle families share their personal stories about the impact that Dance Marathon has had on their journey. Position your brand at the center of one of the most visible and frequently visited areas of the event.

RAVE

During the event, our famous rave hour brings in DJs to perform while our Miracle Makers are on their feet dancing away to the music! Outside visitors can also buy tickets to attend. Gain visibility during a signature experience that attracts participants and visitors alike.

HAPPY HOUR FOR HOPE

Happy Hour For Hope is a signature event held during Dance Marathon at the University of Florida's Main Event weekend. It brings together donors, partners, alumni Miracle Families and members of the greater Gainesville community to celebrate the collective efforts and accomplishments of the past year. The evening features dinner, dancing and a silent auction, offering an elegant conclusion to a year of fundraising and advocacy. Build relationships with alumni, donors, community leaders and longtime supporters of Dance Marathon.

JUMBOTRON

The jumbotron is in the center of Exactech Arena at the Stephen C. O'Connell Center. This is visible by more than 2,000 attendees during the Main Event. The Jumbotron changes often to project different things going on in event, videos, theme hours and more! Maximize your visibility with event-wide exposure to every attendee throughout the Main Event.

BEYOND THE MAIN EVENT

DM at UF holds community events throughout the year, ranging from the Miracles in Color 5k to Miracle Market. All community events can be sponsored, gaining the recognition of both UF students and the Gainesville community. Below are a few of our unique community events throughout the year.

MIRACLES IN COLOR 5K

The Miracles in Color 5K is a vibrant event that follows a course through the University of Florida campus, with both the starting and finishing points located at Flavet Field. Throughout the route, participants pass through a series of colored powder stations, culminating in a celebratory burst of color at the finish line. Showcase your brand throughout the participant experience, from registration to the finish line celebration.

MORALLOWEEN

Moralloween is an annual celebration of our largest fundraising push that happens in the fall! Organizations across campus participate by creating booths with activities, candy and ways to bond with attendees and Miracle Families. Moralloween has a DJ, great food and is a great way for everyone to get in the Halloween spirit! This is one of our best events to reach a variety of audiences.

FUNDRAISING PUSH DAYS

In addition to our Main Event, Dance Marathon at UF hosts Fundraising Push Days to unite the campus and community. In the fall, we hold Transform Today, our largest fundraising push, which brings together our campus for 26.2 hours. In addition, we host other holiday themed push events and campaigns to boost engagement and fundraising around the most celebrated seasons of the year. Some of these include the spring fundraising event, Season of Miracles and our summer campaign. Become part of the momentum that helps transform fundraising goals into meaningful outcomes for children and families.

CHECK-INS

Members of DM at UF participate in weekly check-ins at tabling events held in Turlington Plaza, a central location on the University of Florida campus known for having the highest daily foot traffic. Check-Ins serve as a strategic opportunity to engage with the student body by recruiting potential new members, promoting merchandise sales and facilitating games and activities to foster involvement among prospective and current participants. Reach thousands of students in one of the busiest locations on campus throughout the academic year.

FALL KICKOFF

Fall Kickoff marks the first major event hosted by Dance Marathon at the University of Florida each academic year. Held on campus at the start of the fall semester, this event signifies the beginning of our yearlong efforts. Fall Kickoff features engaging activities, music, stories from Miracle Families, food and more, fostering excitement and unity as we launch into another impactful year. Associate your brand with the excitement and momentum that launches our yearlong fundraising efforts.

MIRACLE MARKET

The Miracle Market is a widely attended event that welcomes participants from the University of Florida as well as members of the Gainesville community. The event features a diverse selection of vendors, including food trucks and local businesses, each of which contributes a portion of their proceeds to benefit DM at UF. Reach a diverse audience of students, families and local community members in a vibrant marketplace setting.

YEARLONG PARTNERSHIP

Partnering with DM at UF is a yearlong commitment and journey. Throughout the entire year, as you provide us with your support, we reciprocate by offering various ways to help benefit your business. Below are some of the opportunities your business can gain access to by supporting DM at UF throughout the year.

1 COMMUNITY EVENTS

Dance Marathon at the University of Florida hosts several community-centered events throughout the year, including Transform Today, Moralloween and Miracle Market. These events provide valuable sponsorship opportunities for our partners, offering visibility among both University of Florida students and the broader Gainesville community.

2 PARTNER POP-UPS

Partner Pop-Ups provide businesses with in-person promotional opportunities during a variety of Dance Marathon activities and events. They allow partners to distribute branded materials and promotional items, while engaging directly with students. Due to high foot traffic on campus, Partner Pop-Ups offer strong visibility among the student body and campus community.

3 SOCIAL MEDIA SHOUTOUTS

Social media shoutouts amplify our partners' visibility through curated posts across Dance Marathon's multi-platform social media presence. With over 32.6K followers across platforms, this audience crosses borders, ages and genders. These promotional takeovers reach a wide audience of engaged followers and help strengthen brand recognition while highlighting your support of our mission.

4 MONTHLY UPDATES

Monthly Updates keep partners connected to Dance Marathon at UF beyond the sponsorship. We believe a partnership with us is more than a business relationship, but a relationship that is mutually beneficial. You will get insight into the impact that you are making by seeing all of the work along the way throughout the year. Through recurring updates, you'll receive consistent insight into the success of our organization, milestones at UF Health Shands Children's Hospital and the personal and professional growth of our students. Get a look at our fundraising efforts, leadership development and the meaningful work taking place throughout the year, while your organization's commitment to improving children's health is recognized by an engaged community of students, alumni, donors, families and supporters.

SPONSORSHIP LEVELS 2026-2027

SPONSORSHIP INCENTIVES	Orange and Blue Buddies (\$250+)	Albert's Army (\$500+)	Swamp Supporters (\$1,000+)	Ben Hill Heroes (\$2,500+)	Florida Fighters (\$5,000+)
Company Name and Logo on DM at UF Website	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
“Proud sponsor of DM at UF” Decal	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Recognition in Post-Event “Thank You”	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Recognition on Partner Wall at Main Event	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Shoutout on Instagram Story and Yearlong Highlights		✓	✓	✓	✓
Recognition in Dance Marathon Program			✓	✓	✓
Recieve Our Quarterly Partner Newsletter				✓	✓
1/4 Page Advertisement in Main Event Program				✓	✓
Opportunity to Table at a DM at UF Event					✓
Opportunity to Hang a Banner at Main Event					✓
Logo on Jumbotron at Main Event					✓
Company Name and Logo on DonorDrive					
1/2 Page Advertisement in Main Event Program					
Receive a Plaque Recognizing Partnership					
Logo on Approximately 1000 Official Event T-Shirts					

*In instances where amenities repeat, partners will be given highest value opportunity.

SPONSORSHIP LEVELS 2026-2027

BENEFIT BY LEVEL	Tebow's Titans (\$7,500+)	Club O'Dome (\$10,000+)	Super Spurrier (\$15,000+)	Gainesville's Greatest (\$20,000+)	Shands Superstars (\$25,000+)	Gator Glorious (\$35,000+)
All Incentives Listed on the Previous Page	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Company Name and Logo on DonorDrive	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
1/2 Page Advertisement in Main Event Program	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Receive a Plaque Recognizing Partnership		✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Logo on Approximately 1000 Official Event T-Shirts		✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Presentation of Plaque During Main Event		✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Full Page Advertisement in Main Event Program		✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Opportunity to Speak at a DM at UF Event			✓	✓	✓	✓
2 Reserved seats at Happy Hour for Hope			✓	✓	✓	✓
Feature on Jumbotron at Main Event				✓	✓	✓
Private Event Tour				✓	✓	✓
4 Reserved Seats at Happy Hour for Hope				✓	✓	✓
Opportunity to Present Check at Main Event				✓	✓	✓
Main Event Award Presented in Your Company Name					✓	✓
Hospital Tour					✓	✓
Full Table at Happy Hour for Hope						✓
Top Donor Bracket Trophy						✓

*In instances where amenities repeat, partners will be given highest value opportunity.

Thank You!

We are always open to working with your business to create an option better suited for you. We want to create a partnership with your business that is mutually beneficial and unique to you. We welcome the opportunity to have further discussions with you about how your business can join us in the fight to Make Big Change, For All Kids.

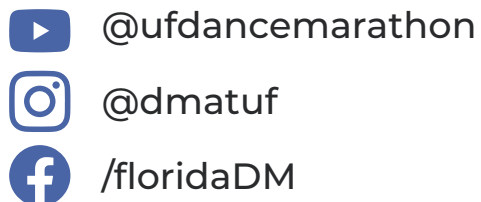
CONTACT US FOR MORE INFORMATION

SPONSORSHIPS OVERALL DIRECTOR

Violet Collins
vcollins@floridadm.org
531-301-4977

VISIT OUR WEBSITE AT:
FLORIDADM.ORG

OR FIND US ON:



CONTACT US OR SEND DONATIONS TO:

Children's Miracle Network
Attn: DM at UF
PO Box 100386
Gainesville, FL 32610

DONATE!

